

To: Prof. Isabelle Augenstein

Email: augenstein@di.ku.dk

Subject: Application for PhD Fellowship in Mechanistic Interpretability for LLM Security — Ref 160571
— Nauval Zulfikar

Dear Prof. Augenstein,

I am writing to express my interest in the PhD Fellowship in Mechanistic Interpretability for LLM Security at the University of Copenhagen, as advertised. I am eager to contribute to the research themes of mechanistic interpretability and LLM security, and I am available to start on 1 September 2026.

Your paper, [TODO: verify supervisor paper title via Google Scholar], has been particularly inspiring for my application. The work's focus on explainable AI and its implications for LLM security aligns closely with my research interests and professional background.

I have a strong foundation in machine learning and NLP, as evidenced by my MSc in Business Analytics from Aston University, where I achieved a First Class (1:1) classification. My dissertation, "Enhancing Supply Chain Information Sharing Systems Through Blockchain: Integrated Customer Reviews LLM Analysis," involved fine-tuning DeBERTa-v3 models, which is directly relevant to the interpretability and security of LLMs.

During my tenure at the Public Works & Spatial Planning Department (PUTR) in Bandung, I led projects that automated ETL pipelines and developed self-service dashboards, improving data efficiency by 20%. Additionally, my role as a Lead Data Scientist at Bank Muamalat Indonesia involved developing NLP models for credit portfolio analysis, which sparked my interest in the technical preconditions of Responsible AI.

I acknowledge that my academic background is in Business Analytics rather than pure Computer Science. However, I have continuously developed my technical skills through various projects and training, such as the NLP Engineer Training at Indonesia AI.

I have attached the required documents, including my CV and transcripts, for your review. I am enthusiastic about the opportunity to contribute to your research team and am keen to discuss how my background, skills, and enthusiasms align with the goals of the PhD project.

Sincerely,

Nauval Zulfikar

zulfikar.nauval1998@gmail.com | +44 7300 469048 | nauvalzulfikar.vercel.app |
linkedin.com/in/nauval-zulfikar